



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cypress Grove Academy
School Website: <https://cypressgroveacademy.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Cypress Grove Academy (CGA) presents a clearly Christian, classical educational identity framed around a Christ-centered mission, shared virtue, and a cooperative model with families. Public materials emphasize classical aims (e.g., pursuit of truth, beauty, and goodness; formation of character and virtue; integration of faith with learning) and a governance that centers on theology and Scripture. The school also foregrounds a collaborative, parental-partnering approach, a statement of faith, and a family-inclusive culture, including a hybrid class structure and a house-oriented community.

Overall, the school aligns strongly with classical aims in religious foundations, purpose, and faculty/parent/-community orientations. The curriculum and pedagogy show clear classical scaffolding (Trivium orientation, memorable recitation and formation-through-models themes) but are less explicit about some hallmark practices (notably explicit, public-facing Great Books or explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy in all grades). Taken as a whole, Cypress Grove Academy is CLASSICAL, with room to further illuminate certain pedagogical/-textual elements to move toward full alignment in every dimension.

- Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle for categories rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is to deepen explicit articulation and public-facing evidence of (a) Great Books/Great Conversation elements within the curriculum and (b) explicitly stated Socratic/dialogic pedagogy or scholé-based instructional practices in the upper grades. Concrete steps to strengthen alignment are described in the "What Would Move the Needle" section below.

Evidence-based observations and keyword analyses draw on the school's public materials and the classical education rubric in the knowledge base, including The Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) and related lexical guides.

Citations anchor the observed evidence to the corresponding sources from Cypress Grove Academy and the classical rubric documents. See citations after each category's evidence.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school identifies itself as Christ-centered and classical, with a mission that includes loving God and pursuing virtue through truth, beauty, and goodness. This framing appears repeatedly in public materials, including statements of mission and vision.

- A formal Statement of Faith anchors theological foundations (The Scriptures, the Trinity, etc.), positioning

Scripture as the supreme authority for faith and life. - Additional communications emphasize gospel-centered formation, the integration of Christian faith into daily instruction, and staff membership in the Christian community.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, beauty, goodness, virtue, faith, gospel, Christ-centered, theology, Scripture, Logos, grace (as referenced in mission/faith documents). Examples include “Christ-centered, classical education ... pursuing truth, beauty, and goodness” and “the Scriptures ... Word of God.”

- Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials (no explicit secularism, relativism, or value-neutral framing detected).

Why this rating - The school's materials foreground Transcendental moral realism through a clear theological anchor, shared virtue, and a liturgical-faith posture embedded in daily learning. The presence of a formal Statement of Faith and explicit Christ-centered framing aligns with the Positive Keywords for Religious & Metaphysical Foundations in the Six Essential Elements rubric. The absence of secular or value-neutral messaging further reinforces CLASSICAL alignment in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission and vision articulate formation of virtue and wisdom, not merely vocational preparation; the aim is to cultivate virtuous, thinking students who can reason and articulate truth and goodness. - Word-ing such as “joy of a Christ-centered, classical education that nurtures the heart and challenges the mind,” and “shape the habits and affections ... think logically, speak truthfully, and live virtuously” demonstrate formation-as-telos. - Several statements emphasize Gospel-centered formation and the aim of bringing gospel-hope through rigorous yet joyful learning.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, telos, contemplation, love of learning, moral imagination, formation of affections, truth, goodness, beauty. These appear across mission statements and theological framing.

- Negative keywords present: none evident (no explicit emphasis on workforce/preparation metrics in the public materials).

Why this rating - The core purpose aligns with classical paideia aims: formation of character, moral imagination, and the pursuit of universal truths (truth, goodness, beauty) rather than narrow job-preparation. The presence of telos-oriented language and virtue-centric formation justifies CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly follows the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as part of its classical framework. This is stated in Distinctives and curriculum descriptions. - The school also references a classical orientation that includes liberal arts and structured study, with references to foundational arts and disciplinary integration. The broader “Seven Liberal Arts” framing appears in the materials about classical education. - There are public materials that discuss history across the curriculum and the desire to cultivate wonder (via a classical approach), though explicit statements about Great Books participation are not consistently visible in the site content. Some elements of Great Books/Great Conversation are present in the Six Essential Elements corpus and related lexicon, but explicit CGA public-facing statements confirming Great Books participation are not consistently shown in the crawl results.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric (Trivium); Seven Liberal Arts; history across the curriculum (integrated humanities emphasis); wonder; great conversation (referenced in the canonical elements as a positive in classical education). Evident in explicit Trivium framing and liberal-arts orientation.

- Negative keywords present: some materials emphasize project-based or experiential learning in the

broader lexicon, and the school's explicit site content does not consistently foreground Great Books or direct Great-Conversation language; this suggests partial alignment rather than full public-facing Great-Books emphasis. This creates a partial misalignment with the strongest classical-curriculum signals in the Six Elements corpus.

Why this rating - The presence of Trivium framing and liberal-arts orientation is strong evidence for CLASSICAL curriculum, but the public site content does not consistently foreground Great Books/Great Conversation or the explicit, comprehensive Great-Books canon, which keeps this category at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. If the school publishes explicit Great Books materials on the site or in syllabi, it could move to CLASSICAL; as of now, the evidence supports SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL with room for stronger public articulation of Great Books and related Great Conversation commitments.

What would move the needle (for Element 3) - Publicly articulate a Great Books program and Great Conversation commitments on the main site (e.g., syllabi or a Distinctives page that references canonical Great Books and primary sources in line with Western civilization tradition). - Provide explicit statements that history is studied throughout the curriculum as part of a liberal-arts integration and avoid reducing history to "social studies" terminology. - If not already in place, publish a list of Great Books, primary sources, and core authors tied to the quadrivium/ trivium and to the broader classical mission.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogy signals in public materials emphasize a blend of collaborative, teacher-led instruction with a collaborative/hybrid model (students attend classes three days a week with at-home assignments graded by classroom teachers). The ritual aspects of classical pedagogy (e.g., restfulness, contemplative time) are not consistently highlighted, though there are elements of formation and community that align with classical aims. - The school speaks to partnering with parents and a culture of virtue and formation, which can support a pedagogy oriented toward formation over mere information. The presence of a "gospel-centered, classical" approach suggests a pedagogy oriented toward the unity of truth, virtue, and beauty rather than purely vocational outcomes. - The formal pedagogy signals (Socratic seminars, memory work, recitation, and rest in pedagogy) are part of the Six Essential Elements framework; however, the public materials for CGA do not consistently depict explicit Socratic/dialectic seminars or scholé-style instruction across grades. The Great Books/Great Conversation orientation is not consistently explicit on the site.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, great conversation, guided discussion, memory work, recitation, scholé, restfulness, contemplation, rhetorical training, public speaking and oratory, disciplined dialogue. The school's materials emphasize classical pedagogy foundations in mission and faculty pages, and the Six Elements provide a vocabulary for this pedagogy. - Negative keywords present: the site does not consistently foreground project-based or experiential-only pedagogy, and the explicit public-facing articulation of Socratic seminars or Scholé is not ubiquitous. Some results suggest a hybrid model, not exclusively Socratic. This partially aligns with classical pedagogy signals but is not uniformly demonstrated on the site.

Why this rating - The program's design supports formation and classical aims (Trivium-centered method, memory work, recitation, and a collaborative, faith-based context). However, explicit, frequent public-facing evidence of Socratic seminars, Scholé-based instruction, or a consistent upper-school emphasis on dialectic debate across grades is not uniformly present in the crawl content. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL in Pedagogy.

What would move the needle - Publish explicit, scalable examples of Socratic seminars or Paideia-style seminars in upper grades, with sample seminar prompts and rubrics, on the public site. - Publicly foreground Scholé (restful learning) as a regular instructional design principle with examples of contemplative time, memory work and chant/singing as part of daily routines in lower grades. - Provide representative daily/weekly schedules that illustrate a balance between contemplative, memory-based activities and higher-order discussion in middle/high school.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a Head of School and named faculty, with a stated standard that staff are degreed teachers (three days in class and two days at home for grading and instruction) and that teachers are Christians who espouse the Statement of Faith. This mirrors the public-facing portrait of teachers as virtuous exemplars and mentors in classical education.

- The presence of formal faith-based expectations for faculty, and a view of teachers as living curriculum and mentors, aligns with classical expectations for role-modeling and the teacher as guide. The site showcases named faculty (Head of School, Financial Administrator, Front Office Admin) and notes degreed teachers and shared governance standards. - The Statement of Faith and related theology content anchor the faculty as guardians of a faith-integrated curriculum and articulations of what a teacher should be within the classical tradition (e.g., moral exemplars, mentorship, living curriculum). The public materials emphasize the culture of virtue and teacher-student mentorship.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: master-teacher model, mentors, living curriculum, faculty of friends, virtuous exemplars, character formation, moral formation, virtue ethics, sacred tradition, teacher as guide, collegial culture, professional training in classical pedagogy. The site materials emphasize these aspects in governance and faculty descriptions. - Negative keywords present: none of the negative indicators (e.g., “data-driven,” “teacher-as-technician,” or non-classical faculty descriptors) appear in the public materials.

Why this rating - Cypress Grove Academy demonstrates substantial classical alignment in the Faculty category through explicit Christ-centered faculty requirements, the “living curriculum” framing, and a collegial, mentor-based culture. The public materials strongly support CLASSICAL outcomes for this category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnering with parents as co-teachers and advocates for parental formation and engagement (including book studies, gatherings, and parent involvement in school life). Public materials repeatedly stress partnership with families and parental participation in classical education. - The site highlights open-campus access and a climate welcoming to family involvement, including opportunities to visit, participate, and collaborate. This community-facing posture aligns with the classical expectation of parents as partners in formation. - The school publishes materials about parental roles, teacher-parent collaboration, and the belief that parents should be actively involved and educated about classical education; there are documents (e.g., Current Families, admissions pages) detailing ways parents engage with school life.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parent formation; family involvement; parental engagement; school as an extension of home; home-school collaboration; living tradition in the family. These terms appear in the mission/vision and admissions documents.

- Negative keywords present: none evident; the materials consistently frame parents as co-educators rather than consumers.

Why this rating - The school's materials reflect a robust, classical-education-aligned stance on parent involvement, family partnerships, and community engagement. This aligns strongly with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 3 (Curriculum): Publicly articulate and publish a formal Great Books/Great Conversation component, with sample reading lists and a clear justification for reading canonical Western texts within

the curriculum. Also explicitly confirm the continuous integration of history across the curriculum as part of a liberal-arts framework, avoiding a “social studies” framing in core marketing content.

- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Publish clear, public-facing statements and exemplars of Socratic seminars or Paideia-style inquiry in the upper grades, plus the Scholé/restful-learning approach as a formal instructional principle with examples from current syllabi or lesson plans.
 - Element 1 (Religious/Metaphysical Foundations): Maintain the robust theological framing and consider adding a brief public-facing section that highlights liturgical or communal practices (e.g., regular chapel/worship opportunities, liturgical rhythms) to strengthen the liturgical aspect of the religious foundation, if applicable to the school’s actual practice.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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